

THE NAKED TRUTH

**How your privacy is dying
a slow death online**

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There is a war going on right now, and unbeknownst to you, you are both the soldier and the casualty in it. Like most wars, this one is made up of a collection of battles rather than a single massive conflict taking place in one spot. However, unlike most wars where the opposing forces tend to be somewhat evenly matched (in one or the other aspect), here we have the behemoths of entire governments along with multi-billion dollar corporations fighting against lone individuals. People like you and me.

Come to think of it, this isn't a war, it's more of a slaughter.

Writing about privacy (or rather the wholesale murder of it), in the wake of the Snowden revelations is a depressing affair. This is not because the fight to regain control over our online lives looks extremely difficult, but rather because we've already lost that fight and the only thing we can do now is try and staunch the bleeding and cauterize the wounds. This process did not happen overnight, no, it happened incrementally as we became more and more willing to choose conveni-

ence over privacy, while companies like Google, Facebook, Microsoft and Yahoo encouraged it – hell, incentivized it. Now, anyone with access to the databases of these companies can paint (and in certain cases, have painted) a complete picture of a person based on their online footprint. And now as the governments around the world tighten the screws on these companies and spy on each other, your privacy is at risk, and as creepy as it may sound, you are, for all intents and purposes, naked to someone with intent and access to your data. Imagine, private emails sent between